THE WEEKEND BUILDER / FREE RESOURCE

The two-weekend build plan

Create a useful first version without making your full-time job, sleep, or family time collateral damage.

Before Saturday: agree on a finish line

Write one sentence describing what a user can do in the first version. Identify one person who will test it. Select a familiar stack. List tasks you are deliberately postponing: multiple roles, elaborate dashboards, subscriptions, and custom infrastructure can wait.

Weekend 1 / Saturday / 30 minutes

Validate the problem with one person. Sketch the main screen and one success state. Choose a single happy path. Define the inputs, the result, and the simplest storage needed. Reserve two build sessions of 60-90 minutes each.

Weekend 1 / two focused build sessions

Session A: implement the smallest end-to-end path using sample data.
Session B: make the main action work with real input. Use AI for bounded tasks with explicit acceptance criteria. Review its output and keep changes in version control.

Between weekends / one short feedback session

Let your tester complete the main task without guidance. Record where they hesitate, what breaks, and whether the result is useful. Select the two issues that most directly block the outcome.

Weekend 2 / make it safe and usable

Fix those two issues. Add clear errors, basic input validation, and a short getting-started guide. Review data handling and permissions. Test the main path, an empty state, and a failure. Share a limited release with your first users.

Sunday evening / define the next experiment

Send one clear invitation. Measure whether users complete the task and return. Write a short retrospective. Choose the next improvement from observed behaviour, not the length of your feature wish list.

WORKSHEET / BUILD WITH AI

Protect your time. Reduce the scope.

A small finished workflow teaches more than a large unfinished app.

One user, one task, one success state

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_____
_____

Tester and agreed feedback time

_____
_____

My available sessions: date / duration / result

_____
_____
_____

Three things the first version will not include

_____
_____
_____

The two biggest blockers from testing

_____
_____

What I will measure after sharing

_____
_____

Stop rule

When the reserved time is up, stop building. Remove scope before adding hours. Next weekend starts with what you learned, not with a promise to catch up.